

Week 2 — Wednesday Lab: Add & Edit with Database Dropdowns

IM102 – Advanced Database Systems | 3 Hours | Computer Lab

Today's Goal

Build add/edit forms where foreign key fields are dropdowns populated from the database.

Example: Category Dropdown in a Form

```
<?php
$categories = $conn->query("SELECT id, name FROM categories ORDER BY name");
?>
<select name="category_id" required>
    <option value="">-- Select Category --</option>
    <?php while ($cat = $categories->fetch_assoc()): ?>
        <option value="<?= $cat['id'] ?>"><?= $cat['name'] ?></option>
    <?php endwhile; ?>
</select>
```

The user sees "Electronics" but the form sends `category_id=1`. Your INSERT stores the ID, not the name.

Example: Pre-Selecting On Edit

When editing, you need the dropdown to show the CURRENT value as selected:

```
<?php while ($cat = $categories->fetch_assoc()): ?>
    <option value="<?= $cat['id'] ?>"
        <?= $cat['id'] == $product['category_id'] ? 'selected' : '' ?>
        <?= $cat['name'] ?>
    </option>
<?php endwhile; ?>
```

The `<?= condition ? 'selected' : '' ?>` pattern checks each option against the stored value and marks the matching one.

Your Turn

Build `add.php` — a form with text inputs for name and description, number inputs for price and stock, and two dropdowns (category and supplier) populated from the database. Validate that required fields are filled. Escape text, cast numbers. INSERT and redirect.

Build `edit.php` — same form but pre-filled. It loads a product by `$_GET['id']`, shows its current data, and the dropdowns pre-select the current category and supplier. UPDATE on submit and redirect.

Add navigation links: "+ Add Product" on `index.php`, "Edit" link per product row.